GIDON **PEEPER**

About me

I am motivated to use AI not just for the sake of using it, but by balancing the stochasticity for optimization and efficiency with determinism for interpretable outcomes. Leveraging the theoretical foundation from my coursework, I have experience in developing and integrating (agentic) AI for, and into my research and work. Furthermore, I enjoy analyzing complex problems from multiple perspectives, which, along with my experience as a teacher and leader of student initiatives, helps me communicate outcomes with stakeholders from different backgrounds. I am excited to join an ambitious, curious, intellectually driven team whose feedback challenges me to think more critically and execute on a high level.

Details

- 06-06-2001
- Princeton, New Jersey
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Technical skills

- Data processing, analysis and visualization
- Deep, Machine and Reinforcement Learning
- NLP/LLMs and Agentic AI

Extracurricular activities

- Founder and President of the Dutch Student Association Princeton (2025 – 2026)
- Social and educational support for a 14–15 y/o neurodivergent student (2022 – 2024)
- Volunteer at Taglit Birthright Onward (2023 – 2024)
- Masterclass Communication and Media at Castro Communicatie (2023)
- Football trainer/coach (2020 – 2023)
- Tutoring, privately and through institutions (2016 – 2023
- International Science Summer Institute, Weizmann Institute (2020)
- Field hockey referee (2017 – 2022)
- Ice speedskating instructor (2015 – 2018)

Hobbies

- Piano
- Gym
- Field hockey
- Football – Princeton Club Soccer
- Ice speedskating
- Running – 4x half marathon
- Skiing
- Snowboarding
- Swimming
- Tennis

Experience

External AI consultant and engineer *2026 – present*
Ayrshare – Unified Social Media API for Scalable Apps & AI Agents

- Designing and implementing multi-modal classification and RAG, and recommendation pipeline.
- Working with existing data-warehouse, code-base and MCP-server.

Research intern and assistant *2025 – present*
Princeton University, Hasson Lab (Neuroscience faculty)

- Using Machine Learning to increase our understanding of how the brain processes and represents naturalistic language, with an emphasis on designing and evaluating meaningful ways to represent linguistic features.
- Working with and integrating new pipelines and features into existing code-base (mostly Python).
- Supervised by Prof. Uri Hasson and Dr. Itamar Jalon.

Summer research intern *2025*
Cognitive AI Lab, University of Amsterdam

- Designing and evaluating LLM vector representations of linguistic features.
- Supervised by Prof. Micha Heilbron.

President of a Dutch National Student Council *2024 – 2025*
Co-founded a national council representing students across all Dutch universities; defined its mission, drafted statutes with legal experts, and assembled and led a nationwide board. Engaged with senior university leaders and national policymakers, including the Minister of Education, supported parliamentary policy-making efforts, and gave media interviews.

Researcher and coordinator *2023*
VU University Amsterdam, Leiden University, University of Amsterdam
Programmed humanoid robots to function as mental-health therapists. Designed study in collaboration with clinical therapists to compare efficacy, alliance and adherence to a screen-based control.

High school teacher — JSG Maimonides *2022 – 2024*
Mathematics, Dutch, and English (9th & 10th grade)

Education

MSc. Artificial Intelligence *2023 – 2026*
University of Amsterdam (UvA)

- Relevant coursework: Machine, Deep & Reinforcement Learning, Information Retrieval, Interpretability/XAI, Natural Language Processing.
- AI Entrepreneurship: co-developed an AI-driven MVP with pharmacies to combat polypharmacy.
- Scholarships: Bischoffsheim, H. Mullerfonds, R. Studiefondsen, St. Vreedefonds, JJSF, JJF.

BSc. Artificial Intelligence — With Honors *2020 – 2023*
VU University Amsterdam
Minor: Entrepreneurship at the University of Amsterdam.

BSc. Psychobiology *2019 – 2023*
University of Amsterdam (UvA)
Additional honors courses; thesis in combination with Artificial Intelligence.

High School *2014 – 2019*
Vossius Gymnasium

- Profile: nature, health and technology, with Latin and economics.
- Treasurer and vice-president of the Student Council; peer mentor for the first grade.
- Thesis on Bitcoin and the Blockchain; extracurricular programming courses.

Publications

- **"Prospective Planning and Retrospective Integration: Distinct Neural Signatures of Future and Past in Naturalistic Conversations"**
  I. Jalon, G. Peeper, H. Wang, Z. Zada, B. Aubrey, A. Bhattacharjee, S. Nastase, A. Goldstein, O. Devinsky, A. Flinker, and U. Hasson
  9th Annual Conference on Cognitive Computational Neuroscience (CCN) – *2026*
- **"Examining the Potential of Social Robots to Increase Adherence in Internet-based CBT"**
  E. A. Konijn, G. Peeper, T. Portegies, N. Garnefski, V. Kraaij, and S. Struijs
  Manuscript accepted, *International Journal of Social Robotics* (SORO) – 2026
- **"NeuroCast: Neural Decoding Benchmarks for Naturalistic Speech in Human ECoG"**
  Z. Paris, A. Bhattacharjee, A. L. Lee, J. Han, D. D. Han, G. Peeper, S. S. Z. Yang, L. Niekerken, Z. Zada, P. S. Scotti, J. Cha, U. Hasson, and I. Jalon
  Manuscript under review, *NeurIPS* – 2026
- **"Distributed Sensitivity to Semantics and Structure Across the Brain During Naturalistic Conversations"**
  G. Peeper, I. Jalon, H. Wang, Z. Zada, B. Aubrey, A. Bhattacharjee, S. Nastase, A. Goldstein, O. Devinsky, A. Flinker, and U. Hasson
  9th Annual Conference on Cognitive Computational Neuroscience (CCN) – *2026*